

Don't be like me. Keeping any kind of planner (without crossing stuff out) will remind you of things you can write off—like “business lunches” (which has a broad definition in Los Angeles). I have a lot of friends who joke that every time we get lunch, they're writing it off. But is it a joke? Are they really keeping track of and writing off every lunch?

When my accountant asked me to look over the past year, all I had were some vague ideas about what I'd done: gigs, meetings, writing assignments. Be better than me. Keep a readable calendar with all your events during the year.

KEEP TRACK OF THINGS LIKE THESE

HOW YOU USE YOUR CAR

How many miles do you drive a year, and for what purpose? How many times a month do you fill up your gas tank? How much do you pay in insurance? Any repairs, car washes, DMV fees?

WHAT YOU SPEND ON YOUR HEALTH

I'm an actress (sometimes), so Dan said I *might* be able to deduct my gym and my therapist (that has nothing to do with being an actress—*or does it?*). Medications can sometimes be deducted. Differing sources say birth control might be a deduction depending on what it's used for. Keep track of all of your health care spending.

ANYTHING YOU SPEND ON YOUR BUSINESS

Purchases made while on the road for business are deductible, so I should keep track of them. Save restaurant and coffee receipts. Save receipts for Ubers, for picking up extra toothpaste, and for anything else bought while out of town. There are apps where you can save digital photos of your receipts so you're not carrying paper around. My friend Myq keeps a folder on his iPhone of just photos of receipts while he travels for stand-up comedy. He was doing this before the apps were invented, so he missed out on being a millionaire, I guess.

If I attend a comedy show to scout new talent for my YouTube channel, Dan said, I can probably write off the ticket price. Great. Now comedy shows are work related! Dan said if I subscribe to any magazines or trade publications, I